

an emotional connect. Also, celebrities work because the audience recognises them," says Deepak Dhar, MD, Endemol India. That is the reason why *Bigg Boss 2* accumulated an average TRP of 3.5 even with its fringe stars while *Sarkar Ki Duniya* hasn't been able to breach the one mark.

show celebrated its first wedding. Neeraj Parashar, a 33-year-old bank manager from Bhopal had been looking for a wife for four years. His search came to an end on national television when as a participant on the show he received 1,700 SMS queries. He finally found Sweccha,

concept may not have worked a few years ago. But it's clear that keyhole viewing is picking up pace.

Aap Ki Kachehri with Kiran Bedi where the audience got a peek inside people's bedrooms ended its first season with an average TRP of four. Feeding on people's need for voyeurism, Star Plus will soon air *Sach Ka Samna* with Rajeev Khandelwal, the Indian version of *Moment of Truth* where participants are asked intrusive questions like "Have you fantasised about another man?" and win money for correct answers. But not everyone is happy. Psychiatrists suggest that the audience has a tendency to get bored and to keep them hooked, channels will only raise the bar. "If there is a conflict, the

right thing would be to have a conversation but that's not exciting TV. If one guy beats up the other then we're talking. This often translates into real life," says neuro-psychiatrist

Rajesh Parikh, adding that this thrill-seeking behaviour is leaving people dissatisfied. The effects are worse on the participants. After their three minutes of spotlight, the contestants are often pushed aside for other more attractive options. "It leaves them dejected and anxious," says Parikh.

Reality is slightly different. A glimpse into a person's drawing room, watching celebrities bare their secrets, a woman facing her fear, two high-on-testosterone men vying for a girl, is all equal to high TRPs. And though reality TV might be only 10 per cent of the total programming on channels, it won't be long before that increases. As Ashish Patil, senior vp, Creative and Content, MTV India, says, "In a very twisted way, reality shows are like car wrecks. It's hard to look away." Never mind the blood. And the bodies. ■



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also from Bhopal, and married her before the week was out.

Competitor NDTV Imagine will soon air *Rakhi ka Swayamvar*. The show, which has already received 12,000 entries, will see Sawant choose her prime time husband. "When the idea came to us we wondered if we'd want to see Rakhi get married on TV. And we realised we would," says Shailja Kejriwal, executive vice-president, content, NDTV Imagine. She agrees that the same

Even the private tradition of marriage is no longer out of bounds. Star Plus launched *Star Vivaah*, an audio-video version of an online matrimonial profile, with a TRP of 1.3 in its first week. And within two months of going on air, the